



WHERE SHOULD YOU SOURCE MACAWIIS FROM?

THE SMART GUIDE FOR SOMALIA TEXTILE BUYERS • Pakistan vs China vs India

You're not just buying from a supplier. You're choosing a country.

	CHINA World's Largest Manufacturer	INDIA South Asia's Flexible Supplier	PAKISTAN Your Direct Supplier — CIF Mogadishu
MOQ	Very High. 5,000–10,000 pcs minimum. Not flexible for small buyers. Forces you to overstock.	Medium. 1,000–3,000 pcs. More flexible than China. Some suppliers do 500 pcs.	■ Flexible. 500–2,000 pcs minimum. Small trial orders welcome. Scale up at your pace.
LEAD TIME (to Mogadishu)	Slowest overall. 45–60 days production. +20–25 days sea shipping. = 65–85 days total.	Moderate. 30–45 days production. +18–22 days shipping via Colombo or Dubai.	■ Fastest. 21–28 days production. +10–14 days DIRECT shipping Karachi→Mogadishu (Maersk).
MACAWIIS QUALITY	■ Mostly Synthetic. Polyester/viscose blends. Somali men dislike the feel. Not authentic checked cotton.	Good Cotton Lungi. Coarser weave. Limited checked patterns. Gujarat suppliers are best.	■ Best Cotton Quality. 100% checked cotton. Faisalabad weave = authentic feel Somali market demands.
PRICE (CIF Mogadishu)	Lowest unit price. BUT: longer shipping adds \$0.30–0.50/pc freight cost. Hidden costs reduce advantage.	Medium price. Similar to Pakistan. No direct shipping route raises landed cost.	■ Best Value. \$1.20–1.40 CIF Mogadishu. Shortest route = lowest freight. Best total cost.
COMPLIANCE & PAYMENT	OEKO-TEX from large factories only. Small ones not certified. Payment via LC or TT only. No Dahabshiil.	BSCI, OEKO-TEX growing. Better than China. Payment via LC/TT. No Dahabshiil accepted.	■ Full Compliance. OEKO-TEX, ISO 9001, WeBOC certified exports. ■ Dahabshiil accepted. 50% advance, 50% on B/L.
WEAKNESS for Somalia	Synthetic macawiis not preferred. Language barrier. No cultural connection. Long shipping, higher freight.	No direct Mogadishu shipping — via Colombo or Dubai. Slower. Some Somali buyers hesitant.	■ No major weakness. Smaller factory capacity vs China. But flexible MOQ covers this gap.

THE HONEST SUMMARY FOR SOMALIA MACAWIIS BUYERS

CRITERIA	■■ CHINA	■■ INDIA	■■ PAKISTAN
■ Price (CIF)	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	■ BEST VALUE
■ MOQ	VERY HIGH	MEDIUM	■ FLEXIBLE
■ Shipping Speed	SLOWEST (65–85 days)	SLOW (48–67 days)	■ FASTEST (31–42 days)
■ Macawiis Quality	■ SYNTHETIC	GOOD COTTON	■ BEST COTTON
✓ Compliance	MEDIUM	GROWING	■ STRONG
■ Dahabshiil	■ NO	■ NO	■ YES
■ Direct to Mog	■ NO	■ NO	■ YES (Maersk)
■ Somalia Trust	LOW	MEDIUM	■ HIGH (rice partner)

THE REAL INSIGHT FOR SOMALIA BUYERS 2026

CHINA Use only for synthetic garments or household goods. NOT recommended for Macawiis. Somali market rejects synthetic feel.	INDIA Good for variety & flexibility. But no direct Mogadishu route and no Dahabshiil payment. Higher total landed cost.	PAKISTAN ■ BEST CHOICE for Macawiis & Textiles to Somalia. Fastest route • Best cotton quality Dahabshiil accepted • Lowest CIF cost.
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